THE ROBOT WHO WANTED TO DANCE



Created by Hamidreza Rostami


In the great Robot Factory,
every robot had a job.
Some built things.
Some fixed things.
Some even told jokes,
though their jokes were
mostly beeps and boops.


B
And Bolt?
Bolt was the
best at sorting.

Bolt could sort a thousand
gears in an hour.
He never missed.
He never dropped.
He was perfect.



“Good work, Bolt!” said Foreman Clank, his big metal hand patting Bolt’s shoulder. “You’re the most reliable sorter we’ve got!”

But one day, as Bolt was sorting, he heard something new. Music.



It came from the far end
of the factory, where
the workers
took their breaks.
A soft, rhythmic sound.
A beat.



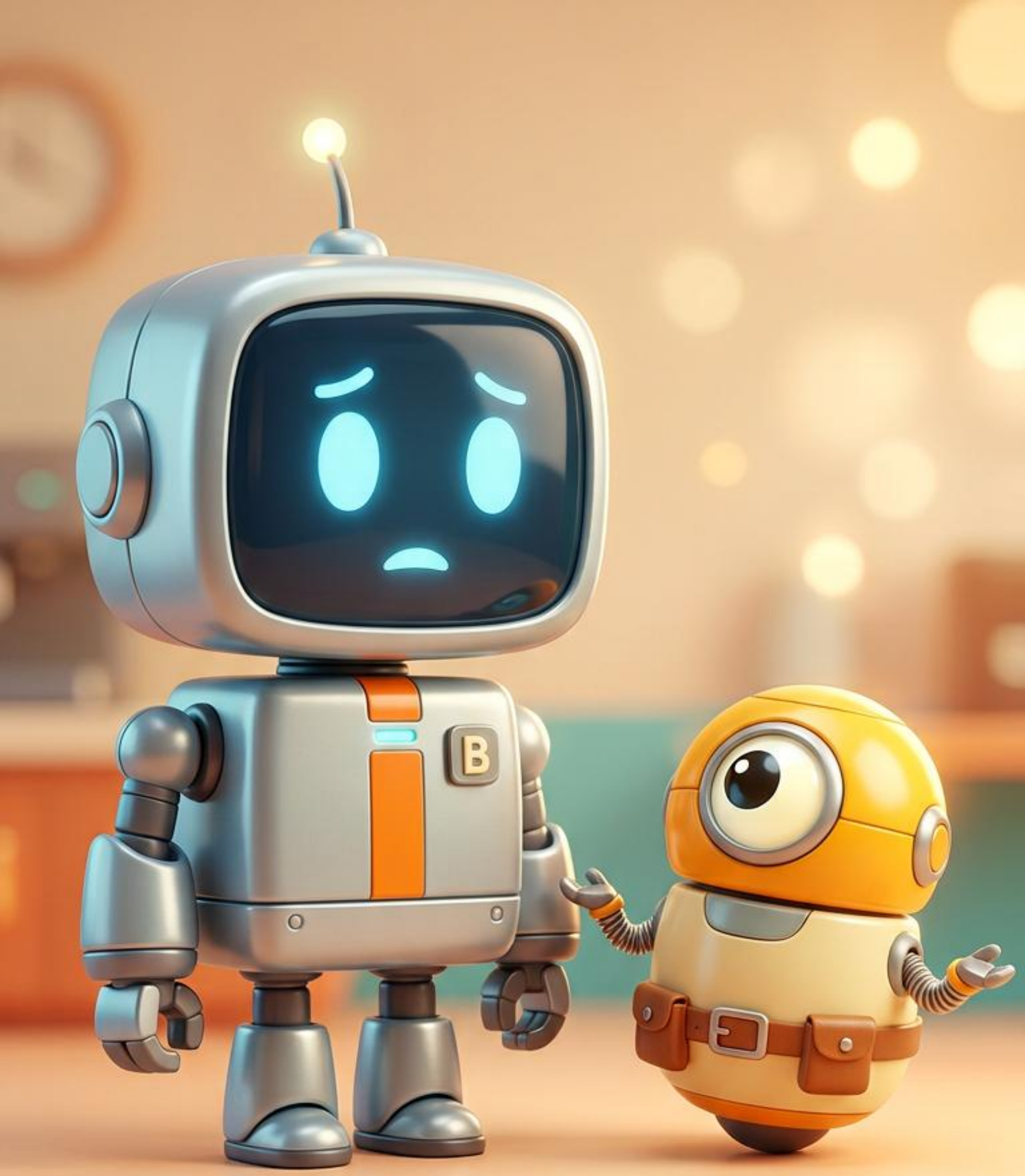
Bolt's head turned.
His eyes glowed brighter.
Something inside him tingled.



He watched as two worker robots swayed to the music.
Their arms moved.
Their bodies twisted.
They looked happy.



Bolt’s circuits buzzed.
“What are they doing?” he asked.
“Dancing, of course!” said Spark,
a small maintenance robot
with a cheerful voice.
“It’s fun! You should try it!”



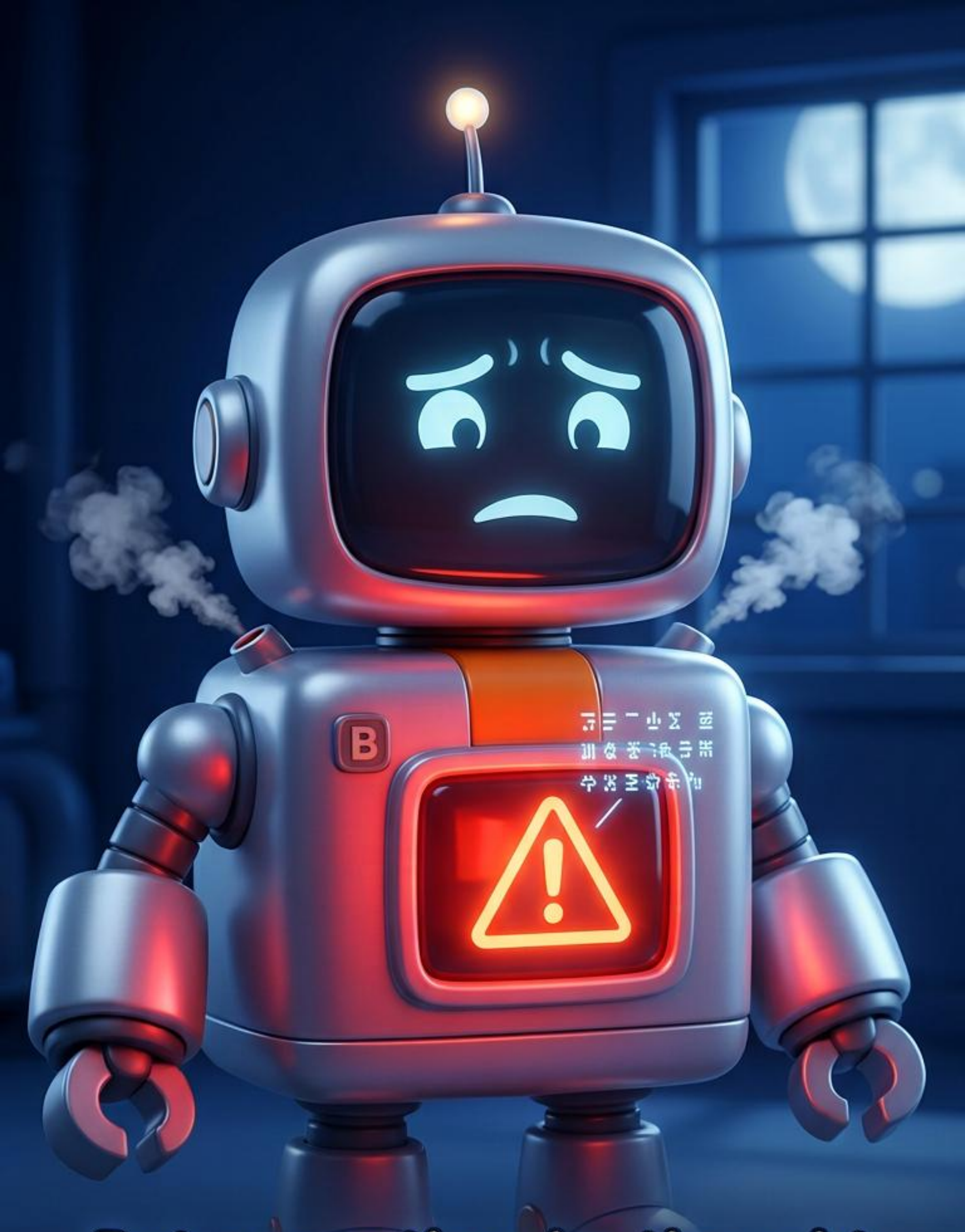
“I... I don’t dance,” said Bolt. “I sort. I am a sorting robot.”

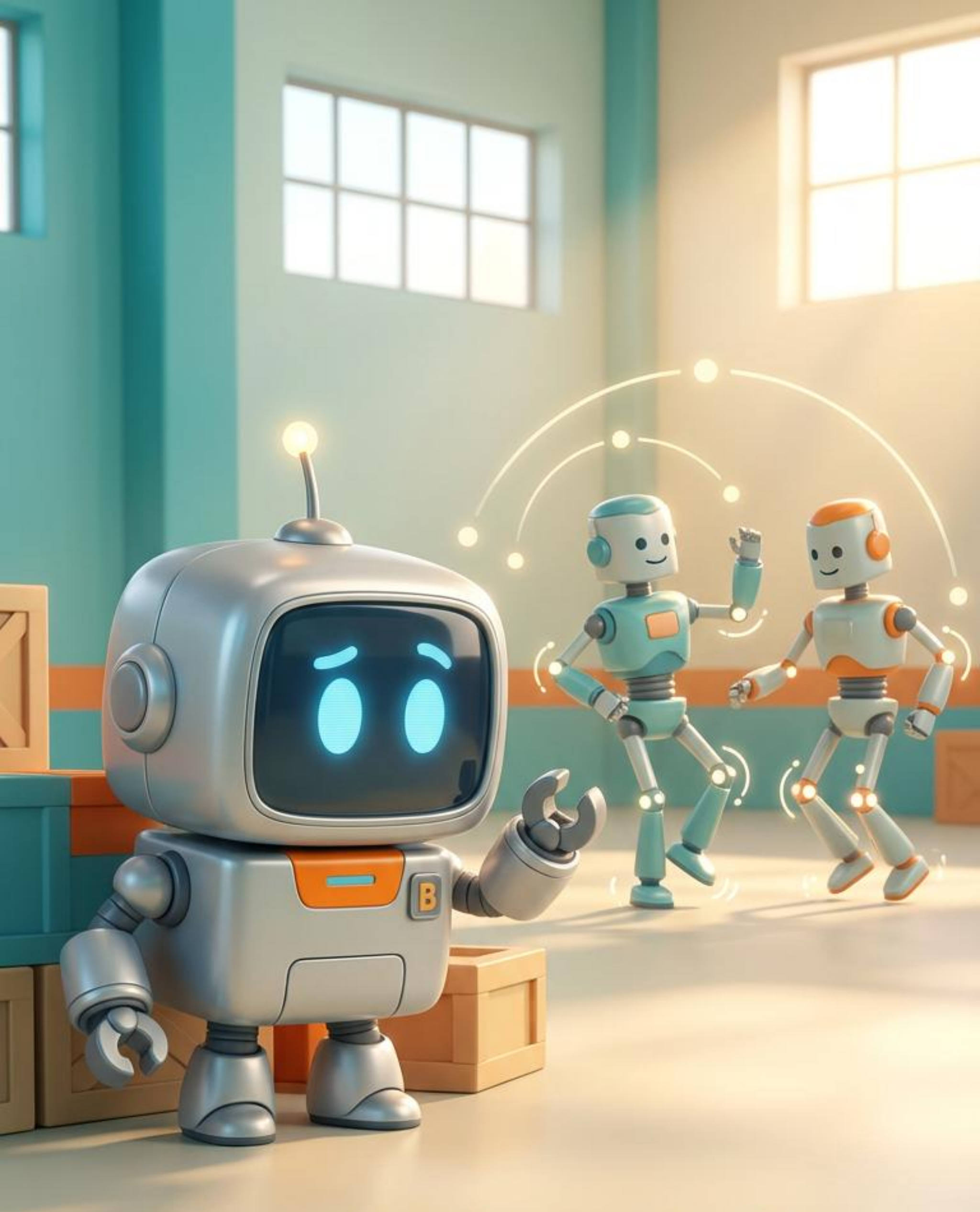


"So?" said Spark.
"You can do both!"

Bolt looked down at his stiff, straight body. His arms were made for grabbing, not swaying. His legs were made for standing, not stepping.
“I don’t think I can,” he said.

That night, in the quiet of the factory, Bolt could not stop thinking about the music. He tried to remember the rhythm. He tried to imagine his body moving.


But every time he thought about dancing, his systems flashed a warning: “ERROR. NOT PROGRAMMED FOR THIS FUNCTION.”



The next day, Bolt watched the dancers again. He noticed how their joints bent. How their feet tapped. How they smiled.

“Maybe... maybe I could try just one step,” he thought.

When no one was looking,
Bolt lifted one foot.
Then he put it down.
Then he lifted the other.
CLANK. CLANK.



It was not graceful.
It was not smooth.
But Bolt felt something
he had never felt before.
Joy.



He tried again. And again.
Each time, his movements
got a little less stiff.
A little more free.
Then Spark saw him.
“Hey, Bolt! You ARE dancing!”



Bolt is the best sorting robot in the whole factory. He never misses and he never drops a single gear.

But one day he hears music drifting from the break room, and something inside him wants to move.

A joyful story about trying something new, being brave enough to be silly, and discovering the very best thing of all to sort: joy.

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